RCS06 | Instructor Guide

CTS Cohort 6 | CTS Day 14 | 2026-07-28 | 10:00 AM-3:00 PM | 6 students

Drywall Installation and Finish Readiness

Core rule: A professional does not guess. A professional checks, protects, and verifies.

Big idea: Finish quality is built through planning: inspect rough-in, measure openings, support the board, fasten correctly, control dust, and protect hidden systems.

Architecture of the day

Time	Instructor move
10:00-10:15	Arrival, PPE, retrieval warm-up
10:15-10:30	Morning quiz
10:30-10:50	Quiz review and pre-cover misconception check
10:50-11:20	Pre-cover inspection and opening-layout model
11:20-12:00	Score/snap, cutout, and panel-handling demonstration
12:00-12:30	Fastener QC, dust-control plan, and lab release
12:30-1:00	Lunch and controlled reset
1:00-2:25	Individual drywall fit and fastening lab
2:25-2:45	Finish-readiness inspection, evidence, cleanup
2:45-3:00	Exit ticket and Day 7 preview

Learning targets

- Complete a pre-cover inspection of framing and rough-in
- Measure and cut a 4-foot by 3-foot drywall panel
- Fit the panel around the window and device boxes
- Fasten and prepare the surface for finishing

Materials and setup

- Six 4-foot by 3-foot drywall panels plus practice offcuts
- T-squares, tape measures, pencils, utility knives, rasps, and panel supports
- Approved drywall fasteners and controlled drivers
- Window/device-box opening templates and pre-cover checklists
- Product SDS, ventilation/housekeeping controls, and required PPE
- Sample tape/compound station and evidence devices

Instructor talking points

- Explain why rough-in and evidence must be complete before covering the wall.
- Demonstrate measurement transfer, box-opening layout, score-and-snap, supported cutting, edge handling, and controlled fastening.
- Compare correct fastener dimples with protruding and overdriven fasteners.
- Introduce tape and compound sequencing; emphasize finish-ready rather than rushed finish.
- Review dust control, housekeeping, and product-specific PPE/SDS requirements.

Whiteboard plan

1. Inspect before cover
2. Measure opening from two references
3. Score -> snap -> back cut
4. Fastener: secure, not torn
5. Dust control and cleanup

Lab facilitation

Each student measures, cuts, fits, and fastens drywall over the 4-foot by 3-foot capstone board while protecting the window opening and electrical training boxes. Students perform a finish-readiness inspection and document corrections.

Lab sequence

6. PPE and pre-cover inspection
7. Photograph rough-in
8. Measure panel/openings
9. Mark and partner-verify
10. Instructor cut approval
11. Score and snap/cut openings
12. Dry-fit
13. Fasten from supported center outward
14. Inspect fasteners and edges
15. Demonstrate tape/compound on sample
16. Dust-controlled cleanup
17. Document and reset

Safety boundaries

- Eye protection during cutting
- Use dust controls and ventilation appropriate to the product/task
- Follow SDS and instructor PPE direction
- Support panels and use team handling when needed

- Keep blades retracted when not in use
- No covering until instructor signs pre-cover inspection

Evidence targets

- Pre-cover checklist
- Measurement/cutout worksheet
- Fitted panel photo
- Fastener QC record
- Finish-readiness inspection

Quiz answer key

1. Why inspect before covering the wall? Hidden framing and rough-in problems become harder to verify or correct after cover.

2. What is score and snap? Cutting the face paper, snapping the gypsum core, then cutting the back paper.

3. What is an overdriven fastener? A fastener that breaks the face paper and loses proper holding quality.

4. Why measure an opening from two reference edges? To locate it accurately and reduce transfer error.

5. What must protect workers during dusty tasks? The task's engineering controls, housekeeping, ventilation, and required PPE/SDS procedures.

6. May drywall cover an unapproved rough-in? No.

7. What should a correct fastener do? Create a slight dimple without tearing the face paper.

8. Why dry-fit before fastening? To verify dimensions, openings, and edge support before committing.

9. What is finish readiness? The board is secure, joints/openings are sound, fasteners are correct, and the surface is ready for the next finishing step.

10. What professional habit applies to cutouts? Measure, mark, verify, then cut.

Exit-ticket look-fors

- Name one pre-cover check
- Describe a correct fastener
- State the dust-control plan
- Name one correction made before approval

Google Classroom post

RCS Day 6 - Drywall Installation and Finish Readiness

Today we focused on finish quality is built through planning: inspect rough-in, measure openings, support the board, fasten correctly, control dust, and protect hidden systems. Students completed guided instruction, hands-on capstone work, verification, evidence capture, and cleanup. Submit your worksheet, lab evidence, and exit ticket before leaving.

Source and safety references

- **Canonical RCS skeleton:** /CANONICAL/00_INBOX/Downloads/rcs_curriculum_plan.md
- **Cohort 6 RCS01 source:** /CANONICAL/02_PROJECTS/CTS_Cohort_06/03_DAILY/D09_RCS01_2026-07-20/Source/lesson.md
- **OSHA PPE:** https://www.osha.gov/personal-protective-equipment/construction
- **OSHA eye and face protection:** https://www.osha.gov/laws-regs/regulations/standardnumber/1926/1926.102
- **OSHA circuit lockout/tagging:** https://www.osha.gov/laws-regs/regulations/standardnumber/1926/1926.417
- **Oregon electrical codes:** https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/codes-stand/pages/electrical.aspx
- **Oregon permits:** https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/lbdd/pages/oregon-permits.aspx

RCS06 | Morning Quiz - Answer Key

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To locate it accurately and reduce transfer error.

5. What must protect workers during dusty tasks?

The task's engineering controls, housekeeping, ventilation, and required PPE/SDS procedures.

6. May drywall cover an unapproved rough-in?

No.

7. What should a correct fastener do?

Create a slight dimple without tearing the face paper.

8. Why dry-fit before fastening?

To verify dimensions, openings, and edge support before committing.

9. What is finish readiness?

The board is secure, joints/openings are sound, fasteners are correct, and the surface is ready for the next finishing step.

10. What professional habit applies to cutouts?

Measure, mark, verify, then cut.

Scoring guidance

One point per item. Accept technically equivalent wording. Use errors to reteach before lab release. Safety-boundary errors must be corrected explicitly before the student begins the related task.

RCS06 | Student Packet

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Learning targets

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Today's run

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2:45-3:00 | Exit ticket and Day 7 preview

Key words

gypsum board | factory edge | butt joint | score and snap | fastener dimple | overdriven | joint compound | tape | pre-cover inspection | dust control

Guided worksheet

1. Complete the pre-cover checklist.

_____

_____

2. Record the panel and opening measurements.

_____

_____

3. Sketch the box/window cutout reference points.

_____

_____

4. Classify three fastener examples: high, correct, overdriven.

_____

_____

5. Write the dust-control and cleanup plan.

_____

_____

Afternoon lab mission

Each student measures, cuts, fits, and fastens drywall over the 4-foot by 3-foot capstone board while protecting the window opening and electrical training boxes. Students perform a finish-readiness inspection and document corrections.

Safety boundary

- Eye protection during cutting
- Use dust controls and ventilation appropriate to the product/task
- Follow SDS and instructor PPE direction
- Support panels and use team handling when needed
- Keep blades retracted when not in use
- No covering until instructor signs pre-cover inspection

Build / test sequence

[ ] PPE and pre-cover inspection

[ ] Photograph rough-in

[ ] Measure panel/openings

[ ] Mark and partner-verify

[ ] Instructor cut approval

[ ] Score and snap/cut openings

[ ] Dry-fit

[ ] Fasten from supported center outward

[ ] Inspect fasteners and edges

[ ] Demonstrate tape/compound on sample

[ ] Dust-controlled cleanup

[ ] Document and reset

Evidence record

[ ] Pre-cover checklist: _____

[ ] Measurement/cutout worksheet: _____

[ ] Fitted panel photo: _____

[ ] Fastener QC record: _____

[ ] Finish-readiness inspection: _____

Reflection and exit ticket

Name one pre-cover check

_____

_____

Describe a correct fastener

_____

_____

State the dust-control plan

_____

_____

Name one correction made before approval

_____

_____

Instructor verification

Status: [ ] Approved [ ] Correct and recheck [ ] Needs follow-up

Instructor initials: _____ Date/time: _____

RCS06 | Morning Quiz

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Drywall Installation and Finish Readiness

Name: _____ Date: _____

Answer from your own understanding. This is a teaching check, not a trap.

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_____

_____

2. What is score and snap?

_____

_____

3. What is an overdriven fastener?

_____

_____

4. Why measure an opening from two reference edges?

_____

_____

5. What must protect workers during dusty tasks?

_____

_____

6. May drywall cover an unapproved rough-in?

_____

_____

7. What should a correct fastener do?

_____

_____

8. Why dry-fit before fastening?

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9. What is finish readiness?

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10. What professional habit applies to cutouts?

_____

_____